

Chrome Web Store as well as in the New Tab page. For help on designing icons, see the “App icon” section of the Supplying Images page: <http://code.google.com/chrome/webstore/docs/images.html>.



Localization files

Unless your app is strictly local in scope, you should internationalize and localize it. Internationalization (or i18n) is the process of making it easy to adapt your app to various languages and regions. You can then localize your app—translate and otherwise adapt it so that it works well in a particular locale.

Even if you don't translate your app, you might want to display different information in the store for different locales. You can do this by modifying the manifest and providing localization files. Details are in the internationalization documentation:

<http://code.google.com/chrome/webstore/docs/i18n.html>

Auto-updating

It's obviously easy to update a hosted app—just update your web server—but it's equally easy to update a packaged app. You just upload the updated ZIP file for your app to the dashboard, and the store and Chrome take care of distributing the new version.

Background processing

Both hosted and packaged apps can perform actions in the background, using a background page or window. They can even request that Chrome start up early and not exit unless the user explicitly quits the browser.

The details of how you implement this capability depend on whether you are writing a hosted or packaged app. For more information, see: <http://code.google.com/chrome/apps/docs/background.html> (hosted apps) http://code.google.com/chrome/extensions/background_pages.html (packaged apps)

Choosing between hosted and packaged apps

This section gives some tips to help you decide which type of app is right for you.

If you already have a web app, you don't need to change it; you can just publish it as a hosted app. However, you might be interested in some of the